

Lesson Information

Topic: What Connects Us

Teacher:	Ed Rush	Date:	5 July, 2026
Class:	M3	Duration:	46 minutes
CEFR Level:	B2	Lesson Shape:	E (Receptive Skills (Traditional))
Materials:	OFD 3, Student Book, pp 5-6		

Lesson Aim

Main Aim: By the end of the lesson, learners will have practiced and developed the sub-skills of reading for gist, detail and specific information and to identify facts and opinions in the context of an article about bridging the generation gap.

Lesson Stages

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
STAGE 1: LEAD-IN			
9 min	To activate interest in the theme of generational differences	- Display or refer to the photo on page 5. In pairs, Ss discuss: What differences do you notice between the two people? In what ways are they the same? Is each person exactly what we expect of someone their age?. - Feedback – elicit responses from pairs.. - In new pairs, Ss tell each other about a time they disagreed with someone from a different generation. What was it about? Did you resolve it?. - Brief whole-class feedback.	Ss-Ss
STAGE 2: READING FOR GIST			
5 min	To get the general idea of the article	- Tell Ss they are going to read an article called 'Bridging the Generation Gap – with empathy'. - Ss read the article quickly and decide: What is the writer's main purpose? (To explore the generation gap and suggest a possible solution.). - Pair check. Whole-class feedback.	Ss-Ss
STAGE 3: READING FOR DETAIL AND SPECIFIC INFORMATION			
16 min	To identify key facts and supporting details in the article	- Ss read the article again and complete the true/false task (Exercise 2). They must correct the false statements.. - Pair check. Whole-class feedback on answers: 1-T, 2-F (By using empathy, people of different ages can communicate and learn to work together better), 3-F (It informs and teaches because it explains what the generation gap is, the problems it might cause, and a possible solution).. - Ss complete the paragraph matching task (Exercise 3). Match statements 1-6 to paragraphs A-F.. - Pair check. Whole-class feedback: 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-E, 5-F, 6-D.	Ss-Ss
STAGE 4: READING FOR INFERENCE AND CONCLUSION			

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
4 min	To draw inferences and evaluate conclusions from the text	- Ss individually decide which statement gives the best conclusion of the article (Exercise 4): a) Learning and change are both easier for younger people, b) Technology often causes conflict between young and old, c) Differences can be good if we take time to understand them.. - Pair check. Feedback – answer: c. Elicit why this is the best conclusion.	Ss-Ss
STAGE 5: POST-READING SPEAKING TASK			
7 min	To discuss and respond personally to ideas from the reading	- In pairs, Ss answer the questions from Exercise 5 using ideas from the article: - Think of one or two things you have now that you think your parents wish they had when they were your age. - Explain something about yourself or your life that you wish the older generation understood better. - Name one or two useful things you've learned from someone in an older generation. 5 min discussion. Content and language feedback.	Ss-Ss
STAGE 6: WRAP-UP AND REFLECTION			
5 min	To reflect on key takeaways and consolidate learning	- Elicit from Ss: What is one thing you learned today about the generation gap? How might you apply the article's tips in your own life?. - Brief error correction if needed.	T-Ss

Answer Key

Unit 1: What connects us?

Reading to learn

Exercise 1

Look at the photo on page 5 and answer the questions.

1. What differences do you notice between the two people?
2. In what ways are they the same?
3. In what ways is each person exactly what we expect of someone their age?

Answers:

- Students' own answers.
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Exercise 2

Study the reading strategy. Then read the article on page 5 and decide if the sentences are true (T) or false (F). Correct the false statements.

1. *The author wrote the text to explore the generation gap and problems it can cause, and to suggest a possible solution.*
 - Answer: T
 2. *The main idea is that it's almost impossible for people from different generations to understand one another.*
 - Answer: F. By using empathy, people of different ages can communicate and learn to work together better.
 3. *The text doesn't inform or teach us, because its purpose is to persuade and influence.*
 - Answer: F. It informs and teaches because it explains what the generation gap is, the problems it might cause, and a possible solution.
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Exercise 3

Read the article again. Match each statement (1-6) to the paragraph (A-F) that gives the information.

1. The generation gap affects people in their job because it means that people of different ages working together may have very different opinions.
 - Answer: B
 2. The writer suggests a change in thinking: choosing to see other generations as working with you rather than against you.
 - Answer: C
 3. The generation gap is the difference between the way older and younger people see the world.
 - Answer: A
 4. It's a good idea to get to know people who aren't your age, and to hear what they think.
 - Answer: E
 5. The generation gap isn't necessarily just a problem; it can also be a great opportunity for learning.
 - Answer: F
 6. Parents should learn about their children's world and not just say they don't like it.
 - Answer: D
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Exercise 4

Which statement gives the best conclusion of the article? a. Learning and change are both easier for younger people. b. Technology often causes conflict between young and old. c. Differences can be good if we take time to understand them.

Answer: c

Exercise 5

Answer the questions. Use ideas from the article.

1. Think of one or two things you have now that you think your parents wish they had when they were your age.
2. Explain something about yourself or your life that you wish the older generation understood better.
3. Name one or two useful things you've learned from someone in an older generation.

Answers:

- Students' own answers.
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Article: BRIDGING THE GENERATION GAP - with empathy

Paragraph A One of the most important jobs parents have is to teach their children about the world and how to live successfully. However, every generation grows up in a world different from their parents'. This often leads to young people feeling that their parents don't understand them, and to parents feeling that their kids' values are wrong. This difference in attitudes and lack of understanding is called the generation gap.

Paragraph B The effect of the generation gap on families is obvious: parents and children frequently disagree about everything from clothes to music to careers. But the generation gap can also be felt in the workplace. As young employees enter companies, they may have completely different expectations from the older generation working in the company. Ideas about work-life balance, what makes a "good" job, and how managers and employees should talk to each other may be very different. This can lead to frustration for everyone.

Paragraph C But does it have to be this way? While it seems obvious to think of your own generation as "us" and the other generation as "them," if we redefine "us" as "our family" or "our company," then we can see both generations as being on the same side - playing for the same team. And if we then truly listen to the people around us - older and younger - with empathy, we can begin to accept that our differences may make us stronger as a team. This means, of course, that while we expect children to learn from their parents, we also expect parents to learn from their children.

Paragraph D That doesn't mean that parents need to adopt their kids' dress sense or listen to their music, but it does mean that parents may need to learn more about the role of technology - for example, social media - in their kids' lives, and possibly even to try it for themselves before they criticize it.

Paragraph E Here are three tips for bridging the generation gap:

- Get to know other generations. Try to socialize with people who are both younger and older than you.
- Learn to really listen and not just think about what you're going to say next.
- Remember: You can learn from anyone, whether they're older or younger than you.

Paragraph F The generation gap isn't going to go away, because the world won't stop changing. But if we start to think of it as a source of learning and growth rather than just a conflict, we may make the world a better place for everyone.